

THE LANTERN NOTES

Cut along the dashed lines. Fold once. Tie or tuck one beneath each lantern before the session.

For the one called PEACHES CAPICHE

When this lantern found you, it did not knock. It settled outside your window and it smelled — impossibly, unmistakably — of home. Of under-the-sea. Of the supper the tide still sets for you. And when you woke, the alligator was already at the door, already facing the lights, already waiting. He has never once been wrong. It is tugging toward the sand.

— found tied beneath the lantern, in wet ink

For the one called WILLIAM BLACKWOOD

When this lantern found you, something was folded inside it. A page. You know the handwriting the way you know your own heartbeat — it is his. But you have never seen this page before, and the ink, when you touched it, was not quite dry. Somewhere, somehow, he is still writing. It is tugging toward the sand.

— found tied beneath the lantern, in wet ink

For the one called PHILIP

When this lantern found you, you read the name on it twice. It is yours — and it is not. It is addressed to the man you are afraid of no longer being: the steady one, the certain one, the one whose hands know exactly what they are for. If you want to know whether he is still in there, the lantern seems to know where to look. It is tugging toward the sand.

— found tied beneath the lantern, in wet ink

For the one called FREYA

When this lantern found you, the name on it was not yours. It bears THEIR names — every one of the people you protect, written small and neat, like an inventory. Someone, somewhere, has made a list of everything you love. You are going to find out who. They will not. It is tugging toward the sand.

— found tied beneath the lantern, in wet ink

For the one called FREYA MOON

When this lantern drifted past your window, you felt it before you saw it: the blossom in your pendant — the last one, the one that has never bloomed — opened. One petal. The first in all these years. Whatever light is out there on the sand, your home's last flower leans toward it like morning. It is tugging toward the sand.

— found tied beneath the lantern, in wet ink